Ysbyty Gwynedd Anaesthetic Guidelines

Awake Fibreoptic Intubation Recipe

Author:
Dr Mark Knights
Acceptance date:
30/11/2018
Review date:
30/11/2021

Key Points:

Preparation, patience & maintaining the confidence of the patient is key.

1. Explain to patient and gain confidence.
2. Anti-sialogogue – glycopyrolate 500mcg at least 30 minutes before (if nasal – also give nasal decongestant)
3. Set up room, equipment, drugs, brief all team members.
4. Full monitoring and oxygen nasal cannulae.
5. Have anaesthetic circuit taped next to head. Have iv induction drugs to hand.
6. Check mucosa is dry – if not repeat glycopyrolate and wait.
7. Start sedation in anaesthetic room. (Remifentanil on its own 0.2mcg/kg/min. No midazolam / propofol!)
8. Local anaesthetic: Lignocaine 4% 4mls gargle for 60 seconds then swallow)
9. Wait a few minutes. Check gag reflex. Spray Xylocaine to any areas not anaesthetised. Patient should be able to tolerate a guedel easily.
10. Check scope orientation. Have further 2mls 4% lignocaine for spray as you go.
11. Perform AFOI. Keep talking to and reassuring patient. Ask them to take a deep breath or say “Ahhh” to open up soft palate / epiglottis.
12. Insert tube – anticlockwise rotation may be required.
13. Check tube position with scope then attach circuit and check capnography.
14. Give reduced dose of propofol induction when happy, then inflate cuff as going to sleep.
15. Check laryngoscopy to document grade of intubation for future reference.

Keywords:
AFOI, Fibreoptic intubation

YSBYTY GWYNEDD ANAESTHETICS

File downloaded on 30-11-2018. Please check website for latest version.